A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

18 May 2026

Dr Amir Khoellar
Bendigo Primary Care Centre

Dear Dr Khoellar,

Re: Mr Malcolm Johnstone
DOB: 10/10/1963 Phone: 0408 511 113
Address: 85 Cruikshank Drive, HUNTLY, VIC, 3551
Email: maljohnstone63@gmail.com

Summary

- **Improvement in bowel frequency and consistency following caffeine reduction and dietary modification.**
- **History of hepatic fibrosis requiring ongoing 6-monthly hepatocellular carcinoma (HCC) surveillance.**
- **For trial of melatonin to assist with sleep.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a review with Malcolm. I am pleased to report that he is feeling much better from a gastrointestinal perspective. His bowel movements are now firmer and significantly less frequent.

This improvement coincides with several major lifestyle changes. Malcolm has significantly reduced his caffeine intake; where he was previously consuming multiple coffees a day, he has now limited himself to the occasional long black. Furthermore, since selling his business, he has been able to exert better control over his diet. He is maintaining a gluten-free and dairy-free diet and has reduced his intake of bread. We discussed that even in the absence of coeliac-related changes on his previous small bowel biopsies, the reduction of caffeine and fructans (found in bread) has likely contributed to his symptomatic improvement.

We also discussed his liver health. As you are aware, Malcolm's previous imaging demonstrated a pattern of hepatic scarring. I have reinforced to him the critical importance of lifelong 6-monthly surveillance to screen for hepatocellular carcinoma. While the risk is present, early detection through regular imaging and blood work allows for much more effective management.

Impression and Plan I have provided Malcolm with two ultrasound request slips to facilitate this 6-monthly surveillance schedule over the coming year. I have also requested he undergo a blood test (including LFTs and AFP) prior to his next review. Regarding his sleep, we discussed the use of neuromodulators such as amitriptyline; however, we have opted instead for a trial of melatonin as a more natural alternative to assist with his sleep hygiene. He is not currently requiring fibre supplementation. I have planned to review Malcolm again in six months' time.

Yours sincerely,

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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